Research Methodology MCCJ 521

Introduction to the course

What is research to you?

Research

Research is a systematic process of gathering, analyzing, and interpreting information to establish facts and reach new conclusions.

It involves a structured approach to investigating a topic, whether it's a problem, a phenomenon, or a theory, with the goal of expanding knowledge and understanding.

Your focus!

What do you want to understand?

Is the concept you are curious about measurable?

How do you measure what you wish to measure?

How can you claim your findings are of any empirical significance?

Live objectively!

A subjective person, but once a researcher, you live objectively!

Researchers observe, they don’t judge

Researchers are open to all ideas, as it is these very ideas they are trying to understand

Social Science researchers have to detach from their own conceptions and perspectives to be able to empathize

Categories

Research can be broadly categorized into basic research (focused on gaining fundamental knowledge) and applied research (aimed at solving specific problems)

Methodology: qualitative (exploring in-depth understanding) or quantitative (relying on numerical data)

Marking structure

Final examination 50 marks

Mid term quiz 20 marks

Quiz 10 marks

Group work 10 marks

Attendance 10 marks

Course texts

Adèr, H. J., & Mellenbergh, G. J. (1999). Research Methodology in the Social, Behavioural and Life Sciences: Designs, Models and Methods (1st ed.). London: Sage Publications.

Bachman, R. D., & Schutt, R. K. (2014). The Practice of Research in Criminology and Criminal Justice (5th ed.). Los Angeles, California: Sage Publications.

Bryman, A., & Burgess, R. G. (1994). Analyzing Qualitative Data (1st ed.). London: Routledge.